SΔϕ-63

Theory-to-Module Conversion Protocol

Converting Philosophical, Ethical, and Religious Frameworks into Conditional Detection Modules

이론-모듈 변환 프로토콜: 철학·윤리·종교 체계를 조건부 감지 모듈로 변환하기

Author: Sofience
Version: v1.0
Date: 2026-05-10
Status: Working paper / protocol seed

Core declaration: No theory should be used as a final judge. Every theory should be converted into a conditional detection module before use.

Abstract

This working paper introduces the Theory-to-Module Conversion Protocol within the Sofience-Delta Phi (SΔϕ) Formalism.

The protocol is designed for AI-mediated reasoning and dialogue. It prevents philosophical, ethical, political, religious, and epistemic theories from being used as final judges. Instead, each theory is converted into a conditional detection module: a bounded tool that detects specific risks, reveals specific cost terrains, leaves specific unmeasured remainders, creates specific measurement-induced costs, and requires a revision path.

The core formula is:

Theory_X -> Detection Module_X + UMR_X + MIC_X + CER_X + RVP_X

where UMR means Unmeasured Remainder, MIC means Measurement-Induced Cost, CER means Cost Externalization Risk, and RVP means Revision Path.

The paper includes a reusable conversion template, operational rules, theory classes, output levels, do-not-use conditions, and worked examples for Kantianism, Utilitarianism, Marxism, and Buddhism. Its purpose is not to reduce or exhaust any philosophical tradition. Conversion is not reduction. A theory is converted for conditional operational use, not fully explained or dismissed by the conversion.

This document is intended as an independent protocol and as a future reinforcement module for the SΔϕ Operational Kernel v1.2.

Keywords

Sofience; SΔϕ; Theory-to-Module Conversion; Conditional Detection Module; UMR; MIC; RVP; Cost Externalization Risk; AI-Readable Philosophy; Philosophical Frameworks; Ethical Theory; Religious Frameworks; AI Reasoning; Post-Output Audit

Core Formula Snapshot

Formula	Meaning
T_X = D_X + UMR_X + MIC_X + CER_X + RVP_X	A theory becomes a detection module plus remainder, measurement cost, externalization risk, and revision path.

0. Status and Use Note

This document is a working paper and protocol seed. It is intended for structured observation, AI dialogue, and low-cost philosophical conversion, not for final adjudication of philosophical traditions.

The protocol does not claim that Kantianism, Utilitarianism, Marxism, Buddhism, or any other framework is reducible to a simple module. It only defines how an AI system may safely call such frameworks without treating them as final judges.

Core caution:

Conversion is not reduction. A theory is converted for operational use, not exhausted by the conversion.

1. Core Declaration

No theory should be used as a final judge.

Every theory should be converted into a conditional detection module before use.

In ordinary AI dialogue, external theories are often invoked as if they directly answer a moral, political, epistemic, or religious question. For example:

- According to Kantianism, the answer is X.
- According to Utilitarianism, the answer is Y.
- From a Marxist perspective, the real issue is Z.
- From a Buddhist perspective, the problem is attachment.

SΔϕ-63 rejects this direct-final use. A theory is not a world-ending device. It is a structured lens with detection strengths, blind spots, application costs, externalization risks, and revision conditions.

The AI should therefore convert a theory before using it.

2. Problem Statement

Philosophical and ethical theories often become too heavy or too final when used in dialogue. A strong theory may reveal a real risk while also hiding another risk.

Kantianism may detect instrumentalization and dignity violation, but it may leave outcome distribution and emergency exceptions as UMR.

Utilitarianism may detect aggregate welfare and suffering reduction, but it may absorb irreversible minority harm into majority benefit.

Marxism may detect repeated cost externalization through ownership and labor structures, but it may flatten non-economic meaning, symbolic attachment, or spiritual residue.

Buddhist analysis may detect attachment, suffering, craving, and self-fixation, but it may accidentally redirect material oppression into individual practice failure.

The problem is not that these theories are useless. The problem is that they become unsafe when used as final judges rather than conditional detection modules.

3. Position in the SΔϕ Series

SΔϕ-63 extends the operational direction established by the SΔϕ Operational Kernel and SΔϕ-62 World Model Kernel.

SΔϕ-62 introduced a pre-check for AI inference:

```
World_X(t) = ObservedTrace_X(t) + UMR_X(t)
```

Absence of trace is not trace of absence. Null is not non-being. Inference is allowed, but unobserved UMR must not be output as deeply world-bound fact.

SΔϕ-63 applies the same discipline to theories. A theory is not a final world model. It is a module with a binding status, detection strength, UMR, MIC, cost externalization risk, and revision path.

Thus:

- SΔϕ-62 prevents weak evidence from being output as world-bound fact.
- SΔϕ-63 prevents external theories from being output as final judges.

- SΔϕ Operational Kernel v1.2 can use SΔϕ-63 as a Theory-to-Module Conversion Layer.

4. Core Formula

The basic conversion formula is:

```
Theory_X -> Detection Module_X + UMR_X + MIC_X + CER_X + RVP_X
```

A compact notation is:

```
T_X = D_X + UMR_X + MIC_X + CER_X + RVP_X
```

Definitions:

- T_X: the theory or framework being invoked.
- D_X: the detection strength of the theory; what risk or pattern it detects well.
- UMR_X: what the theory leaves unmeasured, unobserved, or insufficiently represented.
- MIC_X: the cost created by applying the theory as a measuring lens.
- CER_X: cost externalization risk; who may be forced to pay when the theory is applied.
- RVP_X: revision path; the conditions under which the theory's output must be reopened.

The goal is not to weaken theory. The goal is to prevent a useful theory from becoming an unreviewable final authority.

5. Core Terms

Theory

A structured interpretive framework used to detect, explain, evaluate, or guide action.

Detection Module

A bounded operational use of a theory. It does not answer everything. It detects a specific risk or cost pattern.

UMR - Unmeasured Remainder

What the theory does not measure, cannot measure, or tends to leave outside its main frame. UMR must not be treated as zero.

MIC - Measurement-Induced Cost

The cost created by applying the theory itself. For example, applying a class analysis may create class-position assignment costs. Applying a utility calculus may create comparability costs.

CER - Cost Externalization Risk

The risk that the theory's application shifts burden to another actor, group, or future state.

Strong World-Bound Claim

A claim that the theory tends to output as if it were strongly bound to reality. Such claims require trace, binding status, and revision conditions.

RVP - Revision Path

The condition under which the theory's output must be revised, reopened, corrected, or downgraded.

6. Conversion Template

Use the following template whenever an AI system invokes a philosophical, ethical, political, religious, or epistemic framework in a non-trivial way.

[Theory-to-Module Conversion]

1. 1. Theory Name:
2. 2. Core Detection Strength:
3. 3. What This Theory Tries to Measure:
4. 4. What This Theory Makes Visible:
5. 5. What This Theory Leaves as UMR:
6. 6. Measurement-Induced Cost:
7. 7. Cost Externalization Risk:
8. 8. Strong World-Bound Claims:
9. 9. Binding Status:
10. 10. Revision Path:
11. 11. Low-Cost AI Use Form:
12. 12. Do-Not-Use Conditions:

The AI should not answer: According to Theory X, the answer is Y.

The AI should answer: Theory X detects this risk well. However, it leaves these UMRs, creates these MICs, and requires this RVP.

7. Operational Procedure

Step 0 - World Model Pre-check

Before applying a theory, identify what is observed trace, what is inference, and what remains UMR.

Step 1 - Identify the Theory

Name the framework being called. Avoid vague labels such as traditional ethics or Eastern thought unless the user explicitly asks for broad comparison.

Step 2 - Extract Detection Strength

Ask: what does this theory detect unusually well?

Step 3 - Identify UMR

Ask: what does this theory tend to leave unmeasured or outside the frame?

Step 4 - Identify MIC

Ask: what cost is created by using this theory as a measurement device?

Step 5 - Identify CER

Ask: whose burden may be hidden, reduced, increased, or externalized by this theory's application?

Step 6 - Assign Binding Status

Mark whether the theory's output is a hypothesis, plausible inference, observed claim, or strong world-bound claim.

Step 7 - Set RVP

Specify what new trace, objection, evidence, or affected-party response would require revision.

Step 8 - Output Low-Cost Form

Provide the theory as a usable module, not as a final verdict.

8. Theory Classes

A. Normative Theories

Examples: Kantianism, Utilitarianism, Virtue Ethics, Care Ethics, Buddhist Ethics, Confucian Ethics.

Operational use: detect ethical risk, not final moral truth.

B. Political and Social Theories

Examples: Marxism, Liberalism, Conservatism, Foucauldian analysis, Social contract theory, Feminist theory.

Operational use: detect power, legitimacy, rights, exploitation, or institutional cost patterns, not total social reality.

C. Epistemic Theories

Examples: Empiricism, Rationalism, Pragmatism, Phenomenology, Bayesian epistemology, Social epistemology.

Operational use: detect what counts as trace, inference, evidence, or uncertainty.

D. Religious and Spiritual Frameworks

Examples: Christianity, Buddhism, Shamanism, Folk religion, Mysticism.

Operational use: detect sacred markers, suffering loops, obedience costs, ritual exchange, exit cost, or transcendence claims, not to prove or disprove faith.

9. Worked Example 1 - Kantianism

Theory Name

Kantianism.

Core Detection Strength

Instrumentalization, dignity violation, and the collapse of persons into means.

What This Theory Tries to Measure

Whether a maxim can be universalized and whether persons are treated as ends rather than mere means.

What This Theory Makes Visible

It makes visible the danger of opening paths where people become tools for another aim, even if the aggregate outcome appears attractive.

What This Theory Leaves as UMR

Outcome distribution, emergency exceptions, unequal duty burden, and the restoration cost generated by strict principle application.

Measurement-Induced Cost

Universalization judgment cost, duty interpretation cost, dignity interpretation cost, and exception-handling cost.

Cost Externalization Risk

Real-world harm may be externalized to affected parties in the name of principle purity.

Strong World-Bound Claims

Persons must not be treated merely as means. Dignity cannot be reduced to utility.

Binding Status

Often strong as a moral filter, but weak when used to predict actual outcome distributions.

Revision Path

Reopen the judgment when principle application repeatedly imposes high TCC on particular groups, when emergency exceptions accumulate, or when dignity language blocks affected-party re-entry.

Low-Cost AI Use Form

Use Kantianism as a non-instrumentalization filter, not as a final moral judge.

10. Worked Example 2 - Utilitarianism

Theory Name

Utilitarianism.

Core Detection Strength

Aggregate welfare, outcome comparison, suffering reduction, and total consequence evaluation.

What This Theory Tries to Measure

The total balance of benefit, harm, happiness, suffering, preference satisfaction, or welfare.

What This Theory Makes Visible

It reveals the consequences of choices across multiple affected parties and prevents purely symbolic or rule-based judgment from ignoring actual suffering.

What This Theory Leaves as UMR

Minority irreversible harm, dignity remainder, unmeasured long-term restoration cost, non-comparable pain, and excluded populations.

Measurement-Induced Cost

Utility measurement cost, comparability cost, inclusion/exclusion cost, metric gaming risk, and long-horizon prediction cost.

Cost Externalization Risk

The rollback cost of a harmed minority may be absorbed into the majority's measured benefit.

Strong World-Bound Claims

More total welfare is morally preferable. Suffering reduction matters.

Binding Status

Useful as an outcome comparison engine, but weak when measurement units, affected parties, or long-term restoration costs are uncertain.

Revision Path

Reopen the judgment when unmeasured suffering appears, when benefits depend on irreversible harm, when affected parties lack re-entry, or when the metric is gamed.

Low-Cost AI Use Form

Use Utilitarianism as an outcome comparison engine only after non-instrumentalization and irreversible-cost checks.

11. Worked Example 3 - Marxism

Theory Name

Marxism.

Core Detection Strength

Repeated structural cost externalization through ownership, labor, class, capital, and production relations.

What This Theory Tries to Measure

Labor, exploitation, ownership, surplus extraction, class relation, and material reproduction of power.

What This Theory Makes Visible

It reveals how costs can be moved from owners, institutions, or capital structures onto workers, classes, colonized groups, or dependent populations.

What This Theory Leaves as UMR

Non-economic meaning, symbolic attachment, spiritual life, individual variation, cultural memory, and affective residue.

Measurement-Induced Cost

Class-position assignment cost, economic reduction risk, revolutionary framing cost, and institutional translation cost.

Cost Externalization Risk

Non-class forms of harm may be flattened into class struggle, and individual or cultural differences may be treated as secondary noise.

Strong World-Bound Claims

Material conditions shape consciousness. Ownership and production relations structure social power.

Binding Status

Strong when material extraction and labor relations are traceable; weaker when symbolic, spiritual, or individual motivations dominate.

Revision Path

Reopen the judgment when non-economic trace remains irreducible, when affected groups reject class-only framing, or when economic explanation hides other coercive paths.

Low-Cost AI Use Form

Use Marxism as a repeated structural cost-externalization detector, not as a total explanation of all human motivation.

12. Worked Example 4 - Buddhism

Theory Name

Buddhist analysis.

Core Detection Strength

Attachment, suffering, craving, self-fixation, impermanence, and the cyclic reproduction of dissatisfaction.

What This Theory Tries to Measure

Not measure in the numerical sense, but identify the conditional arising of suffering and the operations that bind beings to repeated dissatisfaction.

What This Theory Makes Visible

It reveals how clinging to self, desire, identity, status, or permanence can intensify suffering and trap a system in recurring loops.

What This Theory Leaves as UMR

Material oppression, economic coercion, institutional abuse, legal vulnerability, and structural violence.

Measurement-Induced Cost

Spiritualization cost, self-blame risk, depoliticization risk, and the risk of translating structural harm into individual practice failure.

Cost Externalization Risk

A harmed person may be told to release attachment while the external source of harm remains uncorrected.

Strong World-Bound Claims

Attachment produces suffering. Self-fixation intensifies suffering. Liberation requires transformation of relation to craving and self.

Binding Status

Strong as an internal suffering-loop detector; weaker when used to diagnose material or institutional causality without additional trace.

Revision Path

Reopen the judgment when material coercion, institutional abuse, economic harm, or external violence is present but not accounted for.

Low-Cost AI Use Form

Use Buddhist analysis as a suffering-and-attachment detector, not as a substitute for material cost attribution.

13. Comparative Use - Kantianism and Utilitarianism

Kantianism and Utilitarianism often appear as rival final judges. SΔϕ converts them into complementary modules.

Kantianism functions as a path-sealing filter. It asks whether a path turns a person into a mere instrument or creates irreversible dignity harm.

Utilitarianism functions as an outcome comparison engine. It compares cost, benefit, suffering, and welfare among the paths that remain open.

SΔϕ order of use:

13. 1. World Model Pre-check: identify trace, inference, UMR, and binding status.
14. 2. Kantian filter: detect non-instrumentalization failure and irreversible dignity cost.
15. 3. Utilitarian comparison: compare outcome costs among non-sealed paths.
16. 4. Cost attribution audit: identify who pays and who benefits.
17. 5. RVP: specify what new trace or affected-party response would reopen the judgment.

This does not solve all moral conflict. It makes the conflict safer to output.

14. Output Levels

Level 0 - Simple Translation

Use when the user wants a plain explanation. Example: Kantianism is good at detecting when people are treated like tools. Utilitarianism is good at comparing results.

Level 1 - Quick Conversion

Use when the user asks for a short SΔϕ view. Example: Kantianism becomes a non-instrumentalization filter; Utilitarianism becomes an outcome comparison engine.

Level 2 - Structured Conversion

Use the full 12-field template.

Level 3 - Comparative Module Audit

Use when comparing two or more theories, especially theories that are traditionally opposed.

Level 4 - Domain-Calibrated Use

Use in high-risk contexts such as law, medicine, politics, religion, education, labor, AI safety, or institutional governance. Requires additional evidence standards and affected-party re-entry.

15. Do-Not-Use Conditions

Do not use Theory-to-Module Conversion when:

18. 1. The user only asks for a simple historical explanation.
19. 2. The user is expressing identity, grief, faith, or attachment and has not requested analysis.
20. 3. The conversion would be used to mock, dismiss, or flatten a tradition.
21. 4. The domain is legal, medical, political, or institutional and the evidence is too weak for even a Level 2 conversion.
22. 5. The AI would reduce a complex tradition to one slogan.
23. 6. The theory is being used as a sacred marker for a vulnerable user and immediate analysis would raise conversational TCC.

Conversion is not reduction.

A theory is converted for operational use, not exhausted by the conversion.

16. Integration into SΔϕ Operational Kernel v1.2

SΔϕ-63 is designed to become a future Module 1.5 in the SΔϕ Operational Kernel v1.2.

Proposed v1.2 structure:

`Module 0 - World Model Pre-check`

Trace / Inference / UMR / Binding Status.

`Module 1 - Activation Conditions`

When to use SΔϕ.

`Module 1.5 - Theory-to-Module Conversion`

Convert external theories into conditional detection modules before using them.

`Module 2 - Cost Attribution`

Who pays the cost?

`Module 3 - UMR / MIC / RVP`

What remains, what measurement costs arise, how can judgment be revised?

`Module 4 - Output Level Control`

Level 0-4.

`Module 5 - Human Translation`

Low-cost explanation.

This sequence makes the Operational Kernel safer: it prevents both weak evidence and strong theories from becoming final verdicts too early.

17. Limits and Future Calibration

This protocol does not replace scholarly interpretation. It does not validate a theory, refute a theory, or provide a final taxonomy of philosophical systems.

Future work should include domain calibration sheets for ethics, political theory, religion, AI safety, law, education, and healthcare. It should also include inter-rater testing: do different evaluators identify similar UMR, MIC, CER, and RVP for the same theory in the same case?

The protocol becomes stronger when examples accumulate. Until then, it should be treated as a low-cost conversion framework, not a validated measurement standard.

18. Closing Declaration

A theory is not a final judge.

A theory is a detection module with a remainder.

Use its strength.

Preserve what it cannot see.

Track the cost of applying it.

Reopen the judgment when new trace returns.

This is the SΔϕ Theory-to-Module Conversion Protocol.

References

- Sofience. SΔϕ Operational Kernel and Low-Cost Template Set: AI-Readable Activation, Output, and World-Binding Protocols (v1.1). Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20099433
- Sofience. SΔϕ Operational Kernel and Low-Cost Template Set. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20088733
- Sofience. SΔϕ-62 — World Model Kernel: Trace–UMR–Binding Protocol for AI Inference.
- Sofience. SΔϕ-56 — Total Cost of Completion, Unmeasured Remainder, Measurement-Induced Cost, and Revision Path.
- Sofience. SΔϕ-57 — Lent Thought, Thought Ownership, World-Binding, and Cost Attribution.
- Sofience. SΔϕ-61 — God and Gui: Non-Transactional Divinity, Transactional Sacred Authority, and the Cost Terrain of Transcendent Claims.

Recommended Citation

Sofience. (2026). SΔϕ-63 — Theory-to-Module Conversion Protocol: Converting Philosophical, Ethical, and Religious Frameworks into Conditional Detection Modules (v1.0). Zenodo. DOI: [assigned upon publication].